Hussein Altaka

Backend / Full Stack Developer · Python & Django

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Baghdad, Iraq

SUMMARY

Backend-focused full-stack engineer, 5 years of production Python and Django. At Apicbase, a Belgian food-tech SaaS serving 500+ client locations, I build backend systems and APIs with Django, PostgreSQL, Celery and AWS. Outside the day job I built, and run on my own, the systems behind two power plants and every college of Al-Nahrain University.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Languages: Python (5 years), JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frameworks: Django (5 years), Django REST Framework (3+ years), Celery

Databases: PostgreSQL (5 years): schema design, query optimization, migrations · Redis (2 years) · Elasticsearch (1 year)

Infrastructure & Observability: AWS (SQS, Redshift, read replicas), Linux, Docker, CI/CD, Git, Datadog, Rollbar

AI-Augmented Development: Claude Code (daily), agent-assisted refactoring and code review

Testing & QA: TDD, Django unittest, Coverage

Frontend: Vue.js 3 (2 years, production), HTMX (3+ years), JavaScript

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer

Apicbase (Food Tech / SaaS)

05/2023 – Present · Remote (EU-based company, Belgium)

- Own the real-time stock pipeline every client on the platform runs on. Moved it off the request path onto an ordered event queue (Amazon SQS FIFO, Celery) and run it in production: live since 2025, every client on it, none rolled back.
- Cut response times 25% across the list and calculation endpoints of our heaviest-data client, and took the slowest inventory pages from 25 seconds to under one.
- Built the analytics dashboard and its API end to end: heavy queries on Amazon Redshift, the rest on Postgres read replicas behind Redis, around 500ms under load on the busiest accounts.
- Built the public REST API for production planning and order fulfilment, so customers' own systems and the mobile app can do work that only the web UI could before.
- Cut CI from 2 hours to 49 minutes, then took test-database setup from 16 minutes to 6 seconds per shard.
- Led the platform-wide move from role-based checks to per-resource policies for every tenant, and closed an authorization gap across all seven WebSocket consumers.

Tech: Python 3.10+, Django 4.2, DRF, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, Elasticsearch, Vue.js 3, Docker, AWS, Git, CI/CD, Datadog

Software Developer

Al-Hadi University College (Higher Education)

08/2021 – 05/2023 · Baghdad, Iraq

- Led the Software Systems & Networks Unit, a 3-engineer team (backend, frontend, mobile), after building and shipping V1 of the college management platform solo.

- Rebuilt the university's public website from scratch: a full-stack migration from legacy PHP to Django, with a full UX redesign and an integrated admissions flow, shipped solo.
- Digitized the student pipeline end to end. An online portal replaced paper admissions for 2000+ students a year, and reached university-wide adoption within one academic year for results, fees and documents.
- Set up the college's first on-premises server alone, from hardware through Linux and provisioning to deploying both the public website and the internal platform. Added Sentry and moved DNS to Cloudflare.
- Integrated a card payment gateway for student fees, among the first universities in Iraq. Behind it a payroll pipeline: fingerprint attendance feeds salary calculation and month-end payment instructions to the bank.

Tech: Django, Python, HTMX, PostgreSQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Linux, Cloudflare

PRODUCTION SYSTEMS

The Two Rivers · Al-Nahrain University · 2023 – present

- The ERP every college of Al-Nahrain University runs on: student records, payroll, finance and research publications for 200+ daily staff.
- Started in the College of Information Engineering, with the Assistant Dean for Scientific Affairs as sponsor, and went university-wide.
- Custom multi-tenant architecture, hardened in a security pass across every tenant boundary. *(Django 4, PostgreSQL, HTMX)*

KMS · Keppt · 2023 – present

- The system Keppt's two combined-cycle power plants run on (730MW and 650MW): 200+ engineers at each plant, 20,000+ work orders, 6,500+ fault notifications.
- Led the migration off Siemens with the plants' engineers and built the replacement alone.
- Every job runs through it, from the fault report and the engineer's analysis to the safety permits and the work order. Stores, HR and quality documents run in it too.
- Built an OAuth2 MCP server on top, so engineers can pull reports through AI assistants. *(Django 4.2, PostgreSQL, Docker)*

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Systems Engineering · Al-Nahrain University, College of Information Engineering
Baghdad, Iraq · 2017 – 2021

LANGUAGES

Arabic: Native · English: C1, working language